CHAPTER 4 | **MIDNIGHT CROSSINGS**

Audre Lorde, Intersectional Poetics, and the Politics of Historical Memory

> A border is a dividing line, a narrow strip along a steep edge. A borderland is a vague and undetermined place created by the emotional residue of an unnatural boundary. It is in a constant state of transition.
> —GLORIA ANZALDÚA

"During these first days of 1984, I would like to share with you and the people of the world my thoughts on a subject of great importance to the cause of peace: relations between the United States and the Soviet Union," stated President Ronald Reagan from the White House East Room in advance of a summit on European disarmament in Stockholm. In this speech, President Reagan shared a New Year's message intended to promote greater communication with his Cold War adversaries. Delivered in the wake of in his own administration's spike in aggressive, anticommunist rhetoric and directives, President Reagan publicly pivoted as he prepared for a new series of diplomatic meetings. A year earlier, President Reagan had deemed the Soviet Union an "evil empire" in the midst of policy initiatives and military interventions aimed at the aggressive Reagan administration "rollback" of socialist governments and forces around the world. He sent U.S. troops or financial support to anticommunist forces in Afghanistan, Nicaragua, El Salvador, Angola, Cambodia, Grenada, and elsewhere.[1]

Divided Berlin further slipped as one of the reaccelerated Cold War's central hot spots, as the leaders from each side of the Wall adjusted the landscape and their policies toward further acceptance of a walled reality. With its newest Wall renovations in place, the GDR removed the tank traps and ground spikes, previously nicknamed "dragon's teeth" and "Stalin's lawn," from the death strip, due, in part, to their harsh appearance and seeming obsolescence. Part of the balance achieved along the Wall was underwritten with covert exchanges between the two Germanys. With options for temporary visas growing, the GDR secretly sent 35,000 migrants across the border for permanent resettlement to help cover economic shortcomings, including paying down loans of over 1 billion deutsche marks